

Arabic Grammar for Understanding Quraan¹ Part VI

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Chapter Outline

Incomplete Verbs

Incomplete Verb كَانَ

Incomplete Verb لَيْسَ

Compound إِسْم

أَفْعَالٌ نَاقِصَةٌ Incomplete Verbs

- Following verbs are **incomplete** without the next word/words:

—	Present/Future	Past	Meaning
1	يَكُونُ	كَانَ	To be —
2	يُصْبِحُ	أَصْبَحَ	To become —
3	لَيْسَ	—	Is not —
4	يَظَلُّ	ظَلَّ	To remain —

- They are also called **كَانَ وَأَخَوَاتُهَا** or simply **كَانَ and her sisters**



Incomplete Verbs أَفْعَالٌ نَاقِصَةٌ Cont.1

- Recall, in Noun-based Sentence or الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّةُ there is an **invisible IS**

Example: اللَّهُ غَرُورٌ Allah **is** pardoning.

Notes:

- ✓ Here اللَّهُ **is the** مُبْتَدَأٌ or early subject which must either مَرْفُوعٌ (or حرف النصب) ✓
- ✓ And غَرُورٌ **is the** خَبَرٌ or late subject which is always مَرْفُوعٌ
- Now if we want to speak like "Allah was pardoning" or "Allah has been always pardoning". Basically we are shifting it to past tense.
Or we want to say "Allah will be always pardoning" shifting to Future Tense.
- In present tense there is no separate word for "IS" but in past and future tense there are separate words (i.e. verb).
Surprisingly these sentences are also noun-based sentences or الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّةُ even if they have verbs.

Incomplete Verb كَانَ Example

- Consider the following الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّةُ

الْأُسْتَاذُ مَوْجُودٌ

The teacher **is** present

Here الْأُسْتَاذُ is the مُبْتَدَأُ or early subject and مَوْجُودٌ is the خَبَرٌ or late subject

- Now we will make it a **past tense**. "The teacher **was** present"
- The arabic sentence will be:

كَانَ الْأُسْتَاذُ مَوْجُودًا

The teacher was present

Incomplete Verb كَانَ Example 1

كَانَ الْأُسْتَاذُ مَوْجُودًا

The teacher was present

Few Points:

- Here كَانَ الْأُسْتَاذُ (i.e. كَانَ + Doer) together will form its مُبْتَدَأٌ or early subject. And the Doer will be always مَرْفُوعٌ (i.e. الْأُسْتَاذُ is مَرْفُوعٌ)
- مَوْجُودًا is its خَبَرٌ or late subject which is normally مَرْفُوعٌ but in this case it must be a مَنْصُوبٌ
- The Doer (i.e. الْأُسْتَاذُ) is called إِسْم of كَانَ while the مَوْجُودًا is called خَبَر of كَانَ
- In summary إِسْم of كَانَ is always مَرْفُوعٌ and خَبَر of كَانَ is always مَنْصُوبٌ

Incomplete Verb كَانَ Example 2

Basic Version	اللَّهُ عَلِيمٌ حَكِيمٌ	Allah is the knowing and knowledgeable
Basic Version2	إِنَّ اللَّهَ عَلِيمٌ حَكِيمٌ	Surely Allah is the knowing and knowledgeable Here إِنَّ اللَّهَ is a حرف النصب and its مُبْتَدَأٌ
Past Version	كَانَ اللَّهُ عَلِيمًا حَكِيمًا	Allah has been always the knowing and knowledgeable

Note: The meaning of كَانَ in the context of اللَّهُ ﷻ becomes "has been always"

Incomplete Verb كَانَ Example 3

- Case I: مُبْتَدَأٌ is an **Independent Pronoun**

Basic Version	هُوَ عَلِيمٌ	He is knowledgeable
Past Version	كَانَ عَلِيمًا	He was knowledgeable

- Case II: Present Tense. Rules remain same.

Basic Version	الْمُعَلِّمُ مُسَافِرٌ	The teacher is a traveler
Future Version	يَكُونُ الْمُعَلِّمُ مُسَافِرًا	The teacher will be a traveler i.e. the teacher will be traveling

Note: In case of كَانَ the inside doer or pronoun is already inside the verb just like نَصَرَ has the doer "HE" in it.

Incomplete Verb كَانَ Outside and Inside Doer

- Rule for Outside Doer and Inside (embedded) Doer is same i.e. **for outside doer the verb will take its he/she form** (no matter of the number of actual doer)

Basic Version (Present)	هُمْ صَالِحُونَ	They are righteous
Inside Doer (Past)	كَانُوا صَالِحِينَ	They were righteous
Basic Version (Present)	الْمُسْلِمُونَ صَالِحُونَ	The muslims are righteous
Outside Doer (Past)	كَانَ الْمُسْلِمُونَ صَالِحِينَ	The muslims were righteous

Note: In case of Outside Doer, even the doer is plural (الْمُسْلِمُونَ i.e. The Muslims) the sentence begins with a singular verb كَانَ (i.e. هُوَ from)



Verb Conjugation of كَانَ

- Present Tense **الفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ**

مضارع

هُوَ يَكُونُ	هُمَا يَكُونَانِ	هُمْ يَكُونُونَ
هِيَ تَكُونُ	هُمَا تَكُونَانِ	هُنَّ يَكُنَّ
أَنْتَ تَكُونُ	أَنْتُمَا تَكُونَانِ	أَنْتُمْ تَكُونُونَ
أَنْتِ تَكُونِينَ	أَنْتُمَا تَكُونَانِ	أَنْتُنَّ تَكُنَّ
أَنَا أَكُونُ		نَحْنُ نَكُونُ

Figure 1: Present Conjugation of كَانَ

- Past Tense **الفِعْلُ الْمَاضِي**

ماض

هُوَ كَانَ	هُمَا كَانَا	هُمْ كَانُوا
هِيَ كَانَتْ	هُمَا كَانَتَا	هُنَّ كُنَّ
أَنْتَ كُنْتَ	أَنْتُمَا كُنْتُمَا	أَنْتُمْ كُنْتُمْ
أَنْتِ كُنْتِ	أَنْتُمَا كُنْتُمَا	أَنْتُنَّ كُنْنَّ
أَنَا كُنْتُ		نَحْنُ كُنَّا

Figure 2: Past Conjugation of كَانَ

كَانَ May be Scattered

- Earlier we have learned that the كَانَ + Doer together form its مُبْتَدَأٌ (or Early Subject) and they are next to each other. But in many cases **the Doer may be far away from its كَانَ verb**. It happens mostly with possessives (لَهُ):

Example:

Basic Version	لَهُ كِتَابٌ	He has a book
Past Version	كَانَ لَهُ كِتَابٌ	He had a book

Note: Here كَانَ + كِتَابٌ together form its مُبْتَدَأٌ although they are not next to each other. And لَهُ is its مُتَعَلِّقٌ بِالْخَبَرِ. The sentence has no خَبَرٌ, so no room to change to its مَنْصُوبٌ status.

- The meaning of كَانَ:** Normally it is translated as "WAS" but at the same time it conveys the meaning of "ACTUALLY" in general and "HAS BEEN ALWAYS" particularly for اللَّهِ

Example: وَكَانَ اللَّهُ غَفُورًا رَحِيمًا And ever is Allah Forgiving and Merciful. -25:70 part



Incomplete Verb لَيْسَ

- لَيْسَ means "it/he is not"
- Unlike كَانَ it has only one form i.e. no form for other tenses.
- Lets begin with the following Basic Example. There are 4 ways to add negative meaning to it (i.e. The house is not big).

Basic Version

الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ

The house is big

Negative Sentence with لَيْسَ Option 1 and 2

Basic Version

الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ

The house is big

- Option 1: Normal way to make a Sentence Negative
- Option 2: Add ب

Option 1	لَيْسَ الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرًا	The house is NOT big
Labels	مُبْتَدَأٌ خَبَرٌ	
Option 2	لَيْسَ الْبَيْتُ بِكَبِيرٍ	The house is NOT big AT ALL
Labels	مُبْتَدَأٌ خَبَرٌ	

- Note for Option 2:

✓ بِكَبِيرٍ is a جَارٌ وَ مَجْرُورٌ and it is the خَبَرٌ here. ب adds emphasis. The sentence has no مُتَعَلِّقٌ بِاَلْخَبَرِ

Negative Sentence with لَيْسَ Option 2 Example

At-Tin 95:8

أَلَيْسَ اللَّهُ بِأَحْكَمِ الْحُكَمِينَ ﴿٨﴾

Is not Allah the Best of the judges???

- The rhetorical question has been emphasised by the use of ب which strongly states that "No doubt Allah is the best of the judges"

Negative Sentence with مَا Option 3 and 4

Basic Version

الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ

The house is big

- Option 1: Use مَا for higher emphasis
- Option 2: Use مَا and ب to further emphasize

Option 3	مَا الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرًا	No, actually the house is NOT big
Labels	مُبْتَدَأٌ خَبَرٌ	
Option 4	مَا الْبَيْتُ بِكَبِيرٍ	No, the house is NOT big AT ALL
Labels	مُبْتَدَأٌ خَبَرٌ	

- Note for Option 3 and 4:
 - ✓ The use of مَا is used to **correct somebody**, adding ب further strengthens it. Option 4 , thus, reflects **the highest level** of a negative statement used for refutation.

Negative Sentence with لَيْسَ Option 4 Example

Al-Baqara 2:74 part

وَمَا اللَّهُ بِغَفِلٍ عَمَّا تَعْمَلُونَ

And in no way Allah is unaware about what you do.

- The statement has been highly emphasized by the use of مَا and ب together which very strongly states that "No doubt, surely Allah is aware of what you do"

Incomplete Verb (لَيْسَ and مَا) Example

- Lets observe the following general example in **4 different ways**:

Labels→	مُبْتَدَأٌ	خَبَرٌ	
Option 1	لَسْتُ	طَالِبًا	I am not a student
Option 2	لَسْتُ	بِطَالِبٍ	I am NOT a student AT ALL .
Option 3	مَا أَنَا	طَالِبًا	No,I am NOT a student.
Option 4	مَا أَنَا	بِطَالِبٍ	No,I am NOT a student AT ALL .

- Note for Option 3 and 4:

Since مَا does not have the embedded doer (i.e. inside doer like لَيْسَ) explicit doer by means of Independent Pronoun أَنَا has been placed here.



مَا + ب Examples from Quran

- IN Quran Allah ﷻ defended His Messenger ﷺ and His message (i.e. Quran) **in the strongest possible way (i.e. using مَا+ب format)** in Sura At-Takwir (81)

Sura At-Takwir 81

وَمَا صَاحِبُكُمْ بِمَجْنُونٍ ﴿٢٢﴾

And indeed your companion (i.e. Prophet ﷺ) is not a madman (**in any way!!!**) (22)

وَمَا هُوَ بِقَوْلِ شَيْطَانٍ رَجِيمٍ ﴿٢٥﴾

And it (i.e. Quran) is not the word of the outcast devil (**in any way!!!**). (25)

Early Subject مُبْتَدَأٌ Details

- In **Noun-based Sentence** or **الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّةُ** the **subject is called مُبْتَدَأٌ** . It is also called Early Subject as it has another subject called Late Subject or **خَبَرٌ**
- There are several ways to **recognize مُبْتَدَأٌ** in a Noun-based Sentence or **الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّةُ**
 - A proper noun or **إِسْمٌ** which is **مَرْفُوعٌ**
Example: **وَاللَّهُ بِصِيرُ الْعِبَادِ** And **Allah** is All-Seer of His slaves. -3:15 part
 - حرف النصب** and its victim
Example: **إِنَّ رَبَّكَ عَلِيمٌ حَكِيمٌ** Verily your Lord is All-Knowing, All-Wise. -12:6 part

Recognizing مُبْتَدَأٌ Cont.1

- Recognize مُبْتَدَأٌ

iii. Independent Pronouns (i.e. هُوَ هُمْ) Recall they are always مَرْفُوعٌ

Example: وَهُوَ الْعَزِيزُ الْحَكِيمُ And He is the All-Mighty, the All-Wise. -59:24 part

iv. Unaffected Pointers (example ذَلِكَ تِلْكَ هَذِهِ) i.e. when they come without any other particle before them like فِي أَلَا

Example: هَذِهِ جَهَنَّمُ this is Hell -55:43 part

v. كَانَ and her Sisters

Example: وَكَانَ اللَّهُ غَفُورًا رَحِيمًا and Allah is always oft-forgiving, most merciful -25:70 part



Multiple مُبْتَدَأٌ A Tool to emphasize

- Consider the following example:

Basic Affirmative	هُوَ أُسْتَاذٌ He is a teacher
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- We can say in Arabic "Surely he, he was a teacher" The **repetition of the Subject** i.e. **Multiple مُبْتَدَأٌ** removes ambiguity and strengthens the claim.

Multiple مُبْتَدَأٌ	اُسْتَاذًا	كَانَ	اِنَّهٗ
Labels	كَانَ of خَبَرٌ	مُبْتَدَأٌ (b)	مُبْتَدَأٌ (a)
Meaning	Certainly he, he was a teacher		

Multiple مُبْتَدَأُ Example from the Quran

- Multiple مُبْتَدَأُ

Example 1		الرَّحِيمُ	الْغَفُورُ	هُوَ	إِنَّهُ
	Labels	(b) خَبَرٌ	(a) خَبَرٌ	(b) مُبْتَدَأُ	(a) مُبْتَدَأُ
	Meaning	Certainly He, He is the forgiving, the merciful -39:53 part			
Example 2		الْمُفْلِحُونَ		هُمْ	أُولَئِكَ
	Labels	(b) خَبَرٌ	(a) خَبَرٌ	(b) مُبْتَدَأُ	(a) مُبْتَدَأُ
	Meaning	They, they are the successful -2:5 part			

- Summary:** Multiple مُبْتَدَأُ through repeated pronouns (i.e. subject pronouns and/or pointers) is a strong mechanism to remove doubt and thus add emphasis on the claim made.
- Conversely,** removal of any of the مُبْتَدَأُ will still make the sentence correct (with base meaning), so, both إِنَّهُ الْغَفُورُ الرَّحِيمُ and هُوَ الْغَفُورُ الرَّحِيمُ are correct sentences.



كَانَ + Present Tense Verb الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ Used To..

- Recall the definition of خَبَرَ (ref. part3 slide 43) can be a complete sentence either الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّةُ or الْجُمْلَةُ الْفِعْلِيَّةُ. **But** in case of كَانَ based sentence, the خَبَرَ can be complete verb-based sentence or الْجُمْلَةُ الْفِعْلِيَّةُ only.
- كَانَ + Present Tense Verb الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ implies either "Used to do.." or "was doing.." The context reveals which one to apply. Generally it reflects the meaning of "Habitual action which was done repeatedly"
- كَانَ + Past Tense Verb الْفِعْلُ الْمَاضِي is rarely used and implies "something happened very long ago"

كَانَ + Present Tense Verb الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ Used To.. Example

- كَانَ + Present Tense Verb الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ implies either "Used to do.." or "was doing.." The context reveals which one to apply. Generally it reflects the meaning of "Habitual action which was done repeatedly"
- كَانَ and Present Tense Verb الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ must match Gender and Number
- Example:

وَلَهُمْ عَذَابٌ أَلِيمٌ بِمَا كَانُوا يَكْذِبُونَ

A painful punishment is for them (i.e. hypocrites) because of what they used to tell lies.
-2:10 part

Note: both كَانُوا and يَكْذِبُونَ are Masculine and 3rd Person Plural

الفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ + كَانَ Used To..More Example

- Example:

فَيَنْبِئُكُمْ بِمَا كُنْتُمْ تَعْمَلُونَ

then He will inform you about what **you used to do**. -39:7 part

Note: both كُنْتُمْ and تَعْمَلُونَ are Masculine and 2nd Person Plural

مَا كَانَ Templates

مَا كَانَ forms a **Negative Templates** in 2 ways:

i.	Template 1	(Y) — اَنَّ (X) — مَا كَانَ لـ
	Meaning	It is not appropriate for X to do Y
	Example:	وَمَا كَانَ لَهُمْ أَنْ يَدْخُلُوهَا
	Meaning	It is not appropriate for them to enter it. -2:114 part

Notes:

- ✓ X is usually a pronoun or a proper name.
- ✓ Y takes its **Light Form** (in present tense) because it comes after اَنَّ particle.

مَا كَانَ Templates Cont.

مَا كَانَ forms a **Negative Templates** in 2 ways:

ii.	Template 2	(Y) — لِي (X) — مَا كَانَ
	Meaning	X would not be one to do Y
	Example:	وَمَا كَانَ اللَّهُ لِيُظْلِمَهُمْ
	Meaning	Allah would not be the one to wrong them. -9:70 part

Notes:

- ✓ X is usually a proper name.
- ✓ Y takes its **Light Form** (in present tense) because it comes after لِي particle.

Compound إسم using أَنْ

- The word أَنْ has 2 meanings:
a) To b) that
- أَنْ makes the Present Tense Verb الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ Light (i.e. مَنْصُوب status of the verb)
- Recall in English Grammar, think of the following sentence:

Walking is good for health or To walk is good for health.

In the first case, "Walking" is called Gerund while the in the second sentence "To walk" serves the same purpose using an infinity "to". In both cases they serve as "Noun". In Arabic it is called "Masdar" or Verbal Noun or Compound إسم

- Consider the following Arabic Example:

يَأْكُلُ means "He eats" while أَنْ يَأْكُلَ means "To eat"

The first one is a complete sentence i.e. الْجُمْلَةُ الْفِعْلِيَّةُ but the second one expresses "an idea" and it serves as a compound إسم or Masdar in Arabic Grammar.

Compound إسم using أَنْ

- So, Light version of **أَنْ + الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ** serves as Noun or **إِسْم**. All roles of an ordinary Noun can be done by this combination as well.
- Examples in Arabic Verbal Sentence **الْجُمْلَةُ الْفِعْلِيَّةُ** :

Example	يُرِيدُ أَنْ يَذْهَبَ إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ
Meaning	He wants to go to the masjid.

- In the above example, the phrase **أَنْ يَذْهَبَ إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ** is replaceable with a Single Noun, hence it is here **Object of the Verb (What) or مَفْعُولٌ بِهِ**

Compound إسم using أَنْ

- So, Light version of **أَنْ + الْفِعْلُ الْمَضَارِعُ** serves as Noun or **إِسْم**. All roles of an ordinary Noun can be done by this combination as well.
- Examples in Arabic Noun-based Sentence **الْجُمْلَةُ الْأَسْمِيَّةُ**

Example	أَنْ تَصُومُوا خَيْرٌ لَّكُمْ
Meaning	That you fast (i.e. Fasting) is better for you. -2:184 part

- In the above example, the phrase **أَنْ تَصُومُوا** appears before "IS" so, it is the **مُبْتَدَأُ** or **subject**

Compound إسم using أَنَّ "that"

- Unlike أَنَّ this أَنَّ particle normally takes a noun or attached pronoun, does not change verb form to light/lightest. But it makes a long fragment of Noun or Compound إسم .
- Example

Example	وَيَحْسَبُونَ أَنَّهُمْ مُّهْتَدُونَ
Meaning	They believe that they are committed to guidance

- In the above example, the phrase أَنَّهُمْ مُّهْتَدُونَ appears as the object of the verb (WHAT), so it مفعول به

تَوَاقُفُ يَوْمَ إِذْ إِذْ

Tense Transformation

New Terms:

New Term	Actual	Expected	Term	Actual	Expected
فِي مَحَلٍّ نَصَبٍ	Something Else	نَصَبٍ	مَنْصُوبٍ	نَصَبٍ	نَصَبٍ
فِي مَحَلٍّ رَفَعٍ	Something Else	رَفَعٍ	مَرْفُوعٍ	رَفَعٍ	رَفَعٍ
فِي مَحَلٍّ جَرٍّ	Something Else	جَرٍّ	مَجْرُورٍ	جَرٍّ	جَرٍّ

تَوَاقُفُ تَوَاقُفُ تَوَاقُفُ

Tense Transformation

There are **two important aspects** of these words or particles:

- i. **Grammar Labeling:** They are always مُضَافٌ no matter what comes after that. The entire sentence or fragment after these words/particles are thus called فِي مَحَلِّ جَرٍّ.
- ii. **Meaning:** These particles shifts the tense as follows (irrespective of the tense of original verb used)
 - a) إِذْ means "When" shifts the context into **Past Tense or** الْفِعْلُ الْمَاضِي
 - b) إِذْ means "When" shifts the context into **Future Tense or** الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ (note it covers both present and future, but here it applies only for future)
 - c) يَوْمَ means "on the day" shifts the context into **Future or** الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ



Example

يَوْمَ إِذْ إِذْ

Affirmative	هُوَ قَائِمٌ He is standing
(i) إِذْ when in Past	إِذْ هُوَ قَائِمٌ He was standing
(ii) إِذْ when in Future	إِذْ هُوَ قَائِمٌ He will be standing
(iii) يَوْمَ when in Future	يَوْمَ هُوَ قَائِمٌ On the day he will be standing

اِذْ Example From Quran

Required Vocabulary:

Essential Vocabulary

يَرْفَعُ

He raises (3rd Masc. Sing, Present Tense)

Recall: اِذْ "when" in Past

اِذْ + Present Tense $\Rightarrow$ Past Tense

اِذْ يَرْفَعُ اِبْرٰهِيْمُ الْقَوَاعِدَ مِنَ الْبَيْتِ

When Ibrahim raised the foundation of the House... -2:127

اِذْ Example From Quran Cont.

Required Vocabulary:

Essential Vocabulary

يَقُولُ

he says (3rd Masc. Sing, Present Tense)

قَالَ

He said (3rd Masc. Sing, Past Tense)

Recall: اِذْ "when" in Past

اِذْ + Present Tense $\Rightarrow$ Past Tense

اِذْ يَقُولُ الْمُنْفِقُونَ وَالَّذِينَ فِي قُلُوبِهِمْ مَّرَضٌ

When the hypocrites and those with sickness in their hearts said.. -8:49

اِذْ + Past Tense $\Rightarrow$ Past Tense

وَ اِذْ قَالَ رَبُّكَ لِلْمَلٰٓئِكَةِ

When your Lord said to the angels.. -2:30

إِذْ Example From Quran

Required Vocabulary:

Essential Vocabulary

جَاءَ

It came (3rd Masc. Sing, Past Tense)

Recall: إِذْ "when" in Future Tense

إِذْ + Past Tense $\implies$ Future Tense

إِذْ جَاءَ نَصْرُ اللَّهِ وَالْفَتْحُ ﴿١﴾

When the help of Allah comes (in future) -110:1

يَوْمَ Example From Quran

Required Vocabulary:

Essential Vocabulary

تَرَى

You see (2nd Masc. Sing, Present Tense)

Recall: يَوْمَ "On the Day" in Future Tense

يَوْمَ + Present Tense $\Rightarrow$ Future Tense

يَوْمَ تَرَى الْمُؤْمِنِينَ وَالْمُؤْمِنَاتِ

On the day (of judgment) you will see the believing man and believing women.. -57:12 part